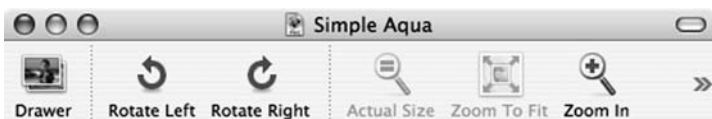


ship in October 2007. As Apple puts it, “Just as Vista tries to get closer, Mac OS X Leopard is right around the corner—ready to leap even farther ahead.” There will be a lot of comparisons of Tiger to Vista in this book, but it is to be noted that Tiger is already a two-year-old operating system, and that the real competitor for Vista is going to be Leopard.

5.2 Look And Feel

The user interface of Mac OS X is called Aqua. It introduced a lot of interface elements into the market such as shadows, transparencies, animations, three dimensional objects, hardware acceleration, etc. The Aqua user interface itself is divided into three kinds of interfaces—simple Aqua, unified Aqua, and Brushed Metal. Applications such as Finder, iChat, Safari, Address Book, iCal, QuickTimePlayer, etc., use the Brushed Metal interface, while most other applications from Apple use the unified Aqua interface. The simple Aqua interface is essentially being phased out but can be seen on some Apple applications such as Chess, Image Capture, Internet Connect, Preview, Sherlock, TextEdit, etc. The pro applications from Apple (which are sold separately) have a different dark theme. The only



The simple Aqua interface

exception to these UI conventions is GarageBand, a hybrid of the unified Aqua, pro, and a unique wooden user interface. Though this causes some inconsistency within various user interfaces in the default set of applications in the OS, the overall look and feel of OS X is aesthetically pleasing and appears well rounded.

When you boot into Mac OS X, you will be greeted with the standard desktop—which consists of the menu bar, a Finder window (the Mac OS counterpart for Explorer in Windows), and the